but you knew from the start it was us, didn't you?

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/45741136.

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General Audiences

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

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by settingmits

Summary

> “Adora!” Catra yells, popping up behind the couch and scaring the woman in question shitless.
>
> “Jesus Christ, Catra,” Adora huffs, hands still gripping the couch cushions. “Don’t scare me like that.”
>
> “Adora,” Catra continues. “Marry me.”
>
> ---
>
> or,
>
> the one where catra and adora pretend to be engaged to try free wedding cake samples

Notes

> this one is for that one friend (you know who u are u bitch) who tried to steal my idea for a catradora fic. i did it first fuck off. love u <3

Adora finds herself reading the same three lines in her book over and over again.

She's been unable to focus on it for the last few minutes, staring blankly at the pages. All that occupies her mind is white noise, if someone were to knock on her skull at this point, it would probably sound hollow.

Her mind is too noisy and too quiet at the same time, and she can feel everything all at once, the pillows on her couch digging into her back, the slight breeze from the open window on her neck and the back of her head.

Somewhere in the background, keys jingle and slot into the door to her apartment, but Adora doesn't process it until her roommate is right behind her.

"Adora!" Catra yells, popping up behind the couch and scaring the woman in question shitless, yanking her violently out of her own head, and she yelps.

"Jesus Christ, Catra," Adora huffs, hands still gripping the couch cushions. "Don't scare me like that."

"Adora," Catra continues. "Marry me."

“W -huh?” Adora’ s heart stutters helplessly in her chest.

“W ell actually not really.” Adora tries to fight the small wave of disappointment. “More like pretend to be engaged to me for a few hours.”

“Why?” She’ s proud to hear her voice doesn’t waver . The butterflies in her stomach are going crazy .

“So we can try free wedding cake samples,” Catra says as if it were obvious. “Think! Free cake! And all you have to do is pretend to be in love with me.”

But I won’t be pretending, Adora thinks. *I really am in love with you.*

She’s been in love with her best friend ever since the eighth grade. Probably since before that, but Adora can’t remember that far back. They’d been best friends all their life, growing up together in the same orphanage, going to school together. They’d even picked colleges close to each other’s so they could share an apartment. Adora can’t remember a time she’d gone more than 48 hours without seeing Catra.

She’s pretty sure if she didn’t see her best friend for over a few days, she’d start having a Catra withdrawal. Glimmer teases her about it all

the time, but it doesnt make it any less true.

Adora pretends to think it over for a moment, even though she'd already decided on going with it the moment Catra suggested it. She would do anything for her best friend, she would run through the middle of a war blindfolded if the brunette so much as thought of it.

"I'll do it," she finally says, grinning, although the butterflies don't stop. "After all, who am I to resist free cake?"

Catra books them an appointment with the bakery a few streets down from their apartment.

("T echnically it's not free," Adora points out.

"Shush, it' s called investment.")

When the day comes, Adora suddenly feels nervous, but those feelings vanish the moment Catra smiles at her.

They arrive right on time. If Adora had her way, they would have been ten minutes early, and if Catra had her way, they would have been ten minutes late. They cancel each other out.

One of the bakers lead them to a room with lots of miniature cakes on a table, and Adora has to physically restrain herself from shoving them all in her face.

"Congratulations on the wedding, by the way," the baker says. "You two seem good together, a good match."

"Thank you," Catra says smoothly, and Adora just blushes.

After (totally useless) talking, the couple' finally get to taste the cakes.

Adora stuffs her face with a red velvet cake first, earning a laugh from Catra when she gets some frosting on her nose. And then she almost earns herself a heart attack when Catra leans over the table to wipe the frosting off her nose, sticking it in her mouth.

Catra attempts to start a fight when she flicks a piece of vanilla strawberry cake onto Adora's forehead, but the blonde resists, no matter how much she wants to smear cake into Catra's face.

“I’m going to be the responsible adult here,” she says, “and I’m not going to have a food fight with you in someone else’s bakery.”

Catra sticks her tongue out. “You’re no fun.”

And Adora knows it’s childish, but she sticks her tongue out back. Catra squints at her before turning back to her cake.

Then, Adora has an idea. She scoops a piece of her chocolate cake onto her spoon and holds it up in front of Catra.

“Open wide,” she says.

Catra grins and leans forwards. She maintains eye contact with Adora while she takes the spoon into her mouth, and the blonde suddenly feels very hot. Catra just smirks at her.

Eventually, they finish the first few cakes, and the staff clear up their plates to bring in another round, but they linger a little at the door. Adora can feel eyes on them.

“Adora, I need you to kiss me,” Catra whispers to her, and Adora nearly chokes on air. “They’re looking, so maybe laugh or something first to make it believable.”

This is how I die. goodbye, cruel world, Adora thinks. "Okay ," she agrees, because of course she does. "Tell me something funny."

Catra grins and leans in conspiratorially. "Once, I accidentally put a whole spoon of salt in my coffee instead of sugar and I spit it out so hard that some of it came out of my nose. I was coughing for like five minutes straight. Tell anyone and you're dead meat."

It catches Adora off guard, and she genuinely laughs. Of course Catra would do that. God she loves her so much.

Adora's head dips with her laughter, and she leans against Catra trying to stabilize herself. And then she's looking up at her friend, and they're suddenly close enough that their noses are brushing. She leans up slowly, heart beating in and out her ribcage, lodging itself in her throat. Catra leans down to meet her in the middle, eyes fluttering. Their lips brush once, twice, and then Catra is pushing forwards, slotting their mouths together properly.

Adora brings one hand up to grasp at the back of Catra's neck as they break apart, pulling her in for another. Catra groans and for a moment panic sets into Adora's body, thinking she's done something wrong, but Catra grabs her by her hips, holding her in place.

And then it hits Adora like a freight train. She's kissing Catra. She's kissing her best friend. The thought alone is enough to make her

dizzy. And god, this kiss feels too real for something that's supposed to be fake.

They pull apart for good this time, and Adora can't help the "Woah." that slips out of her. She's sure she looks starstruck.

"Alright lovebirds," one of the attendants cuts in, smiling as they bring in another set of miniature cakes. "We've still got a few more cakes to go today."

They make it through the rest of the tasting, though Adora can't keep her smile off her face the entire time, and from the looks of it, Catra's having trouble holding in her own.

Stuffed full of cake and another appointment booked for tomorrow, Catra and Adora walk back to their apartment hand in hand, bumping shoulders and laughing all the while.

"Hey, Adora?"

"Yeah?" Adora looks over at Catra, who's smiling softly, blush dusting her cheeks.

"Thank you for doing this with me."

“Of course,” Adora says. “Anything for you. And the cake,” she adds as an afterthought.

Catra’s laughing again, and Adora thinks nothing sounds better than it. Nothing gets better than this.

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